Nature’s Window — water, wind and rock ⏱ ~25 min

NAME _____ DUE _____ SCORE / EFFORT _____

1 · Read

Nature’s Window

In Kalbarri National Park, about six hundred kilometres north of Perth, the Murchison River has cut a deep, winding gorge through layers of red and white sandstone. This sandstone formed from sand that was laid down in flat layers hundreds of millions of years ago, long before there were any dinosaurs.

High above the river sits one of the park’s most famous sights: Nature’s Window, a natural arch of layered rock. Visitors climb up to it and look through the gap to see the river bending far below, framed like a picture.

How did the window form? Some layers of sandstone are softer than others. Over a very long time, wind and rain weathered the weaker layers, and the loose grains were eroded away. The harder layers above were left standing, creating a hole right through the rock.

The river has been doing the same kind of work on a much larger scale. Each time it floods, the fast-moving water carries sand and pebbles that scrape the bottom and sides of the gorge, making it slightly deeper and wider.

2 · Questions

1. What is Nature’s Window, and where is it?

2. Why did a hole form in the rock instead of the whole rock wearing away evenly?

3. Find **one** example of weathering and **one** example of erosion in the text.
Weathering:

Erosion:

4. Write the main idea of the last paragraph in **five words or fewer**.

5. Underline the noun groups:
a) *a deep, winding gorge* b) *layers of red and white sandstone* c) *the fast-moving water*

6. Write **two** noun groups of your own to describe the river. Use a precise adjective in each.

3 · Compare

7. Complete the table.

	The Pinnacles	Nature's Window
Type of rock		
Main shaper(s) — wind, water or both?		
One thing that makes it special		

4 · At home

8. Explain to someone at home the difference between **weathering** and **erosion**. Then look around your home, garden or street for **one** example of weathering or erosion (e.g. a worn step, a crack in a path, soil washed onto a footpath). Draw or describe it in two sentences.